COUNTY COUNSEL'S IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF: MEASURE "Z"

The Board of Trustees of the Lassen Library District (the "District") has placed Measure Z on the ballot. Measure Z proposes increasing the District's existing special parcel tax from Twenty-Eight dollars ($28.00) to Fifty dollars ($50.00) per year for each habitable parcel and each living unit of multiple living unit parcels within the City Limits (each, a "Parcel") of the City of Susanville (the "City").

The District provides public library facilities and services to residents within the City. The existing special tax of Twenty-Eight dollars ($28.00) per Parcel has not been increased in thirty-two (32) years. According to the District, current tax revenue is insufficient to sustain operations without additional funding.

This measure authorizes a special tax under Article XIIIC, Section 2 of the California Constitution and Government Code Sections 50075, 50077, 53717, and 53717.2.

If approved, the increased annual tax of Fifty dollars ($50.00) per Parcel would take effect July 1, 2027, and be collected in the same manner as ordinary ad valorem property taxes.

The increased tax is expected to generate approximately One Hundred Ninety-Four Thousand Six Hundred dollars ($194,600.00) in annual revenue. Proceeds must be deposited into a separate account and applied only for public library facilities and services, including: library materials and collections; facility operations, maintenance, and improvements; technology and digital resources; literacy, educational, and community programs; and library staffing and professional services.

Pursuant to Government Code Section 50075.3, the District must file an annual report with its governing board on funds collected, expended, and the status of projects funded by the tax.

This measure provides no exemptions. The special tax applies uniformly to all Parcels and continues annually until repealed by voters or the District's governing board. The District may not increase its rate or extend its duration without voter approval.

Approval requires at least two-thirds of votes cast, as required by Article XIIIC, Section 2(d) of the California Constitution. If the measure fails, the existing annual tax of Twenty-Eight dollars ($28.00) per Parcel remains in effect.

A "yes" vote favors increasing the District's special tax from Twenty-Eight dollars ($28.00) to Fifty dollars ($50.00) per year for each Parcel.

A "no" vote opposes increasing the District's special tax and favors retaining the existing Twenty-Eight dollar ($28.00) tax per year for each Parcel.

This Impartial Analysis is hereby submitted to the Elections Officials in conformance with Section 9313 of the Elections Code of the State of California. If you desire a copy of the measure, please call the elections official's office at (530) 251-8217 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you. You may also view the full text of Measure Z at: https://www.lassencounty.gov/194/Elections.

Dated: August 12, 2026

/s/ Andrew D. Plett
Lassen County Counsel

ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF: LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT SPECIAL TAX MEASURE "Z"

Lassen Library District was established by voters in 1994 as a California Special District funded by a $28 annual tax on each habitable dwelling within the District. This assessment provides approximately $109,000 annually for library operations. The library receives no funding from the City of Susanville or Lassen County.

For more than three decades, the tax rate has remained unchanged while the cost of providing library services has increased dramatically. Inflation and rising expenses for property insurance, utilities, technology, and other essentials have steadily reduced the purchasing power of these tax dollars. As a result, the library is operating at a deficit, has postponed routine maintenance, and is projected to deplete its reserves if additional local funding is not secured.

A "Yes" vote on Measure Z would increase the annual tax from $28 to $50—an increase of $22 per year, or less than $2 per month. This modest investment would help restore financial stability, balance the operating budget, and maintain the current level of library hours, staffing, collections, programs, and public services our community depends on.

Popular services include children's story time and summer reading programs, internet and computer access, printing and scanning, book clubs, GED and literacy programs, and community meeting space.

The District successfully secures grants for additional services and important building improvements. However, grant funds are restricted and generally cannot be used for the day-to-day operating expenses required to keep the library open and serving the public.

Measure Z will provide stable local funding to preserve these essential services and ensure that the Lassen Library District remains a valuable community resource for residents of all ages for years to come.

Dated: August 3, 2026

/S/ Alfred Vazquez
/S/ Marilyn Shears
/S/ Margie Meserve

NO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE "Z" WAS SUBMITTED

FULL TEXT OF LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT SPECIAL TAX MEASURE "Z"

MEASURE Z- PRESERVE OUR LIBRARY

A MEASURE BY THE LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT BOARD OF TRUSTEES ADJUSTING THE SPECIAL TAX FOR LIBRARY FACILITIES AND SERVICES

SECTION 1. AUTHORITY AND PURPOSE

This Ordinance is adopted pursuant to California Constitution Article XIII C, Section 2, Government Code Sections 50075, 50077, 53717, and 53717.2, and Article 3.5 (commencing with Section 50075) of Chapter 1 of Part 1 of Division 1 of the California Government Code. Cal Const, Art. XIII C § 2, Cal Gov Code § 53717, Cal Gov Code § 50077, Cal Gov Code § 53717.2, Cal Gov Code § 50075. The increase in the special tax on habitable parcels and units of real property authorized by this measure shall be used exclusively to provide public library facilities and services within the Lassen Library District.

SECTION 2. DEFINITIONS

For purposes of this Measure the following definitions apply:

A. "Parcel" means any habitable parcel of real property within the City Limits of the City of Susanville, California, as shown on the latest Lassen County Assessor's parcel maps. It also includes regarding multiple family units each habitable unit of said multiple residential units

B. "City Limits" means the incorporated boundaries of the City of Susanville, California, as they exist on July 1 of each fiscal year in which the tax is levied.

C. "Library Facilities and Services" means all public library facilities and services described in Chapter 1.5 (commencing with Section 18010) of Part 11 of the California Education Code, including but not limited to: acquisition of library materials; operation and maintenance of library facilities; technology and digital resources; literacy and educational programs; and staffing.

SECTION 3. CONTINUED LEVY OF SPECIAL TAX

1. Commencing July 1, 2027, the current levy by the District of a special tax on each habitable parcel and each living unit of multiple living parcels shall be increased from twenty-eight dollars ($28.00) per fiscal year to fifty dollars ($50.00) per fiscal year on those habitable parcels and units so described within the City Limits of the City of Susanville.
2. The special tax authorized by this Measure shall replace and supersede the existing library parcel tax of Twenty-Eight Dollars ($28.00) per Parcel per fiscal year currently levied on Parcels and habitable individual multiple units within the City Limits.
3. The special tax shall be levied annually and shall continue until repealed by the voters or the governing board of the District.

SECTION 4. COLLECTION

The special tax shall be collected in the same manner as ordinary ad valorem property taxes are collected and shall be subject to the same penalties and the same procedure, sale, and lien priority in case of delinquency as applicable to ad valorem taxes.

SECTION 5. ACCOUNTABILITY MEASURES

Pursuant to Government Code Section 50075.1, the following accountability measures are established: Cal Gov Code § 50075.1.

FULL TEXT OF LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT SPECIAL TAX MEASURE "Z" CONTINUED

1. Specific Purposes. Proceeds of the special tax shall be applied only to the following specific purposes: providing public library facilities and services within the District, including but not limited to: library materials and collections; library facility operations, maintenance, and improvements; technology infrastructure and digital resources; literacy, educational, and community programs; and library staffing and professional services.
2. Separate Account. All proceeds from the special tax shall be deposited into a separate account established and maintained by the District.
3. Annual Report. The District shall file an annual report with its governing board pursuant to Government Code Section 50075.3 stating the amount of funds collected and expended and the status of projects funded by the special tax.

SECTION 6. EXEMPTIONS

No exemptions from the special tax are provided under this Measure. The special tax shall apply uniformly to all habitable Parcels within the City Limits of the City of Susanville. Cal Gov Code § 53717.

SECTION 7. APPROPRIATIONS LIMIT

Pursuant to California Constitution Article XIII B, the appropriations limit for the District could be affected by the aggregate sum collected by levy of this special tax in each year that the tax is levied.

SECTION 8. SEVERABILITY

If any section, subsection, sentence, clause, or phrase of this Measure is for any reason held to be invalid or unconstitutional by a court of competent jurisdiction, such decision shall not affect the validity of the remaining portions of this Measure. The voters hereby declare that they would have adopted this Measure and each section, subsection, sentence, clause, and phrase thereof, irrespective of the fact that any one or more sections, subsections, sentences, clauses, or phrases be declared invalid or unconstitutional.

SECTION 9. EFFECTIVE DATE

This Measure shall take effect July 1, 2027 upon approval by two-thirds of the voters voting on the measure at the election held on November 3, 2026, pursuant to California Constitution Article XIII C, Section 2(d). Cal Const, Art. XIII C § 2.

SECTION 10. AMENDMENT

This Measure may not be amended by the District's governing board to increase the special tax rate or extend the duration of the special tax without voter approval as required by the California Constitution.

BALLOT SUMMARY FOR LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT SPECIAL TAX MEASURE "Z" CONTINUED

This Measure would increase the existing library special tax from $28 to $50 per parcel per year for habitable parcels within Susanville city limits. Funds would support library materials, facility operations, technology, educational programs, and staffing. The tax would continue annually until repealed. An annual report would be required. Approval requires a two-thirds vote. Cal Elec Code § 13119, Cal Const, Art. XIII C § 2.

TAX RATE STATEMENT FOR LASSEN LIBRARY DISTRICT SPECIAL TAX MEASURE "Z"

STATEMENT PURSUANT TO CALIFORNIA ELECTIONS CODE SECTION 9401

The following information is provided pursuant to California Elections Code Section 9401 regarding the special tax for library facilities and services to be levied by the Lassen Library District if Measure Z is approved: **Cal Elec Code section 9401**

1. Best Estimate of Average Annual Tax Rate

The special tax approved by this measure is a flat parcel tax of $50.00 per year per habitable parcel or unit for multiple living units parcels per year and is not an ad valorem tax based on assessed valuation. The tax will be levied at the rate of $50.00 per parcel or unit annually for each parcel or unit within the City limits of the City of Susanville, California.

Final Fiscal Year: The tax is not subject to a sunset date and will continue to be collected annually until repealed by the voters or the District's governing board. It will be effective July1, 2027.

2. Best Estimate of Highest Tax Rate

Because the special tax is a flat $50.00 per parcel and not based on assessed valuation, the actual dollar amount levied per parcel will remain constant at $50.00 per year and will raise approximately $194,600.00 per year

3. Total Debt Service

This measure authorizes a special tax, not a bond issuance. No debt service will be incurred. This statement is provided for informational purposes only as required by Election Code Section 9401. **Cal Elec Code section 9401.**